

Chapter 104-3

Liang Shi's heart was about to leap out of her chest. Her mind went completely blank.

It was much scarier than watching the horror movie that day. She had no idea what she should do, where would be safe to go now.

She just wanted to leave.

While she was still in shock, a hand grabbed her foot—it seemed to be a glowing figure.

She had clearly already thrown away the mirror. As long as she didn't look, she wouldn't encounter such terrifying in-your-face jump scares again. But an NPC wearing fluorescent white grabbed her foot and stuffed something near her feet.

Liang Shi didn't feel what the NPC had stuffed there at all—just seeing her figure was enough to make her scream.

The two NPCs' eardrums probably felt like they'd been shattered, but it was only one scream. After the initial fright, Liang Shi stood in place, motionless.

She didn't know what she was supposed to do now.

Until she heard Xu Qingzhu say: "Liang Shi, just find a corner to hide in. I'll come find you."

The foot that had been grabbed by the NPC had already lost all feeling. She numbly moved her body and curled up in a dark corner.

This feeling was very familiar, as if she had experienced it many times before.

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Liang Shi seemed to have fallen into a boundless deep sea, surrounded by endless seawater that was about to engulf her completely.

Memories kept rewinding, tinted with dim, gray colors, like an old movie from the last century playing.

Those forgotten things surged toward her like tidal waves, all stuffing themselves into her mind.

All the memories about darkness.

She had curled up in darkness like this more than once.

Including the original host's memories.

When her luck value had reached 80 before, the system said she had unlocked the usage rights to this body and gave her partial memories. But most of those were bright ones, without too many special things.

The system said most of them were occupied by the original host's powerful consciousness, who was unwilling to give them to her, and the Grievance Management Bureau couldn't forcibly seize the memories.

But now... many dark memories came flooding in.

In a dark basement, she was curled up in a cold corner, with a girl wearing a blue princess dress beside her.

That was Qi Jiao.

Qi Jiao sat shoulder to shoulder with her, hugging her knees, and asked: "Why did your mom send you here?"

She said: "I don't know."

Qi Jiao asked her: "Did you do something wrong?"

She still shook her head: "I don't know."

At that time, she wasn't even as old as Ling Dang was now—she was truly at an age where she didn't understand anything.

She didn't know what she had done wrong, nor did she know why Qiu Zimin had sent her here, using the excuse of giving Qi Jiao another playmate.

After a while, she said in a muffled voice: "I broke a vase that Mom liked."

Qi Jiao said: "It's just a vase. Can't you just buy another one?"

"Mom said I was being naughty and not well-behaved."

"....."

The childish conversation echoed in the dark space, but before long, Qi Jiao was called away.

According to Qi Jiao when she returned later, because there were guests at home, she needed to change into a brand-new, beautiful princess dress, take a nice fragrant bath, and then play piano in front of the guests.

But she played one note wrong.

Too many people had come. She was too nervous, too afraid of making mistakes, yet she still made a mistake.

Originally, no one would have been able to notice, but the visitors were her father's old classmates, and their son was also learning to play piano.

That note was an insignificant one for that piece—even if played wrong, it wouldn't affect anything. Yet that little boy happened to catch it and immediately said loudly after she made the mistake: "You played it wrong!"

This caused her to pause in the middle.

Although she carefully finished playing the entire piece afterward without making any more mistakes.

She was still belittled by her father in front of the guests because of that note, and she could only lower her head and admit her fault.

And her mother's expression was not pleasant either.

That little boy went up and played a piece, flowing and effortless. Afterward, he bragged to Qi Jiao that his piano teacher was the internationally renowned piano master XXX, and that he practiced piano for seven hours every day.

But Qi Jiao's piano teacher was a music department teacher at some university—several levels below that little boy's teacher. Moreover, she had too many classes to take every day: piano, calligraphy, painting, violin, posture training, ballet. The time she could allocate to practicing piano was extremely limited—having one hour was already a luxury.

Besides, she didn't even like piano in the first place.

What Qi Jiao loved most was ballet—wearing a beautiful dress standing on stage, with the lights shining on her, she could dance along with the rhythm.

The teacher who taught her ballet had told her that she had great talent and was born to stand on stage.

But Yang Jiani preferred piano, so Qi Jiao's piano had to be outstanding.

People have no enthusiasm for learning things they don't like. Every time she practiced piano, Qi Jiao forced herself to do it.

Because she didn't want to disappoint Yang Jiani and wanted to make her happy, even though she was practicing something she didn't like, she put in her full effort.

At such a young age, she had too many things to remember.

When she played that note wrong, she had been very anxious.